

Brad Cole

Designer • Web Developer •
Digital & Creative Technology

Location: Vancouver, BC V6J 2B3
Phone: 778-321-7441
Email: bradcoledesign@gmail.com

SUMMARY

Designer and web developer with professional experience spanning graphic design, web design, UI design, usability, branding, front-end development, WordPress, Joomla, client communication, and independent freelance work.

My background combines formal design education with hands-on experience working with agencies, businesses, and independent clients. I have worked across both visual and technical aspects of projects, including information architecture, navigation, content hierarchy, interface design, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, WordPress, client communication, proposals, project coordination, and print production.

I have also operated independently as a freelance designer and sole proprietor, including prospecting, client interviews, proposals, project planning, billing, and delivery. My entrepreneurship experience has been largely self-taught rather than based on formal business training, and I am interested in developing those skills further.

After spending many years as the primary caregiver for my son while continuing independent creative and technical projects, I am now looking to build a sustainable source of income. I am open to employment, additional practical training, employer-supported training, and entrepreneurship/self-employment programs that build on my existing skills.

AREAS OF INTEREST

- Web Design & Development
- Front-End Development
- UI / Usability Design
- Application & Software Support
- SaaS / Technical Support
- Software Implementation & Client Onboarding
- Web & Digital Content
- Technology Coordination
- Healthcare Technology / Application Support
- Freelance Web & Design Services
- Entrepreneurship & Supported Self-Employment

CORE SKILLS

Design

- Web and UI design
- Information architecture
- Navigation and content hierarchy
- Typography and layout
- Branding and visual identity
- Logo development
- Print design and production
- Image sourcing, selection, optimization and correction
- Illustration
- Advertising and promotional design

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CORE SKILLS CONTINUED..

Web & Technology

- HTML
- CSS
- JavaScript
- React
- WordPress
- WordPress PHP
- Joomla / Gantry
- Responsive web design
- Front-end development
- Figma
- Adobe Creative Suite
- Affinity By Canva
- Git / modern front-end development workflows

Client & Business

- Client interviews and requirements gathering
- Presenting design concepts
- Project communication
- Proposal development
- Freelance project management
- Prospecting and outreach
- Pricing and billing
- Content organization
- Business-to-client communication
- Working independently

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Designer & Web Developer

Various Vancouver agencies, businesses and independent clients

Worked independently and through Vancouver-area creative agencies on a wide range of design, web, branding, print and digital projects.

Selected responsibilities and experience:

- Designed and developed websites from initial concept through implementation.
- Created web layouts, UI designs, navigation structures and content hierarchies.
- Developed websites using HTML, CSS and JavaScript.
- Designed and developed WordPress websites, including WordPress PHP customization.
- Worked with Joomla and Gantry.
- Created logos, identities, packaging, promotional materials and advertising.
- Selected, optimized and corrected client-provided and sourced imagery.
- Worked directly with clients to understand requirements and develop solutions.
- Prepared proposals, discussed project terms and managed freelance projects.
- Produced print-ready documents, publications, posters, labels and promotional materials.
- Provided typography, typesetting, copywriting and editing.
- Collaborated with creative agencies on short-term projects and production work.

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE CONTINUED..

Freelance Designer & Web Developer Continued..

Selected Projects Included:

- Complete WordPress website for a water sports company.
- Website and UI work for businesses in trades, healthcare, physiotherapy, property management and other service industries.
- City of Vancouver website prototype development.
- Ballroom dance instruction website.
- Golf course, physiotherapy and fingerprinting websites.
- Dental-office email campaigns.
- Branding, logos and packaging for multiple businesses.
- Publication and document design.
- Digital ad design.
- Animated promotional material for a Vancouver transit campaign.

Web Marketing Director

Express Computers

9-month subsidized employment placement.

- Conducted client interviews and gathered website requirements.
- Designed internal and client-facing websites and interfaces.
- Worked with HTML, CSS, Joomla, Dreamweaver, Photoshop, Illustrator and InDesign.
- Helped develop the company's new web-design service offering.
- Created a services and pricing reference document for sales staff.
- Consulted on CMS offerings and participated in minor CMS development.
- Worked on information architecture, navigation, content hierarchy and layout.
- Produced internal print materials and promotional work.
- Wrote a news release for the launch of the company's web-design department.
- Participated in a newspaper interview concerning the launch of the new design department.

Independent Designer / Owner

Protonic Design

Operated an independent design business providing branding, web and graphic-design services.

- Developed the business identity, website and marketing materials.
- Participated in BNI networking and direct prospecting.
- Conducted client interviews and discussed project requirements.
- Prepared proposals and tracked prospective clients.
- Created logos, company identities, stationery and websites.
- Designed website information architecture, navigation, content hierarchy and layouts.
- Worked with HTML and CSS as well as Adobe Creative Suite.
- Managed client communication, project administration and billing.
- Worked with a business coach for guidance while learning the practical realities of running a small business.

Entrepreneurship note:

This was hands-on experience rather than formal entrepreneurship training. I learned primarily through doing the work, networking, prospecting and managing projects, and I would welcome further practical training in business development, pricing, marketing, client acquisition and sustainable self-employment.

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE CONTINUED..

Designer / Web & UI

Rook Technologies

First professional design position following graphic-design education.

- Designed websites and user interfaces
- Worked on usability, navigation, information architecture and content hierarchy.
- Created corporate identities, logos, stationery, booklets and promotional materials.
- Produced print layouts and production files.
- Used Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign and Dreamweaver.
- Worked with HTML and early web technologies including Flash.
- Sourced and selected photography and other visual assets.
- Performed photo correction and manipulation.
- Developed advertising copy and visual concepts.
- Assisted with office/environmental design.
- Worked on projects for technology companies, professional services, organizations serving people with disabilities, music-related businesses and other clients.

Earlier Customer Service, Retail & Operational Experience

Moore's Clothing For Men - Suit Sales (Approximately 2 Years)

- Took customer measurements.
- Helped customers select and coordinate clothing.
- Provided product knowledge and customer service.
- Handled cash and retail transactions.

A&B Sound - Software CSR (Approximately 7 Years)

- Assisted customers in finding music and software products.
- Recommended products based on customer interests.
- Used computerized inventory systems to locate products.
- Priced and organized merchandise.
- Maintained product organization by genre and alphabetical order.
- Developed extensive product knowledge and customer-service experience.

Other Employment

Additional experience includes:

- Save-On-Foods – Meat Department / Photography Development
- Safeway – Cashier
- Donald's Market – Stocking / Customer Service
- Future Shop – Retail
- Chapters Indigo – Seasonal Retail
- The Bay – Seasonal Suits Department
- Building Maintenance / HVAC Monitoring
- Automotive Body Shop – Assistant / Body Work
- Subway – Sandwich Artist

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE CONTINUED..

Independent Creative & Technical Projects

Abstract Drawn

Independent abstract-art youtube channel project exploring imaginative interpretation, visual perception and expression.

- Developed a distinct visual identity and online presence.
- Created original artwork and photography/video content.
- Maintained social-media presence and artwork listings.
- Experimented with online distribution, print sales and audience development.

Jam Canopy

Independent music youtube channel project focused on creating original electronic backing tracks for musicians to improvise over.

- Composed and produce original music.
- Explore electronic production, arrangement and sound design.
- Work with FL Studio and other digital music-production tools.
- Create and publish original video content.
- Continue developing skills in recording, production and digital content creation.

Independent Web & Technology Projects

I continue to develop personal web-development projects to maintain and expand current skills, including React, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, responsive interfaces and application concepts.

Family & Independent Work Period

Primary Caregiver & Independent Creative/Technical Work

Following the birth of my son, I became the primary caregiver while my wife worked as the household's primary income earner. During this period I continued developing professionally through independent work and self-directed learning, including:

- Freelance and independent web/design projects.
- Graphic and abstract artwork.
- Online creative projects and content.
- Web development and programming study.
- React, JavaScript, HTML and CSS training.
- UX, usability and design study.
- Independent technology and SaaS project development.
- Music production and digital media projects.
- Ongoing reading and self-directed study in design, technology and related subjects.

I am now transitioning back toward paid employment and/or sustainable self-employment.

Independent Guitar Instructor

- Taught guitar fundamentals and music theory.
- Explained scales, chords, triads, modes and related concepts.
- Adapted explanations to individual students.
- Emphasized understanding and improvisation rather than simply memorizing material.

After becoming unable to continue previous physical work, I taught a small number of private guitar students.

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EDUCATION & TRAINING

Scrimba – Frontend Developer Career Path

Online Training – 2024

Training in modern front-end web development, including HTML, CSS, JavaScript and React.

Graphic Design for Marketing Diploma

Kwantlen University – 2004

Interdisciplinary Design Certificate

Kwantlen University – 2002

Fine Arts Studies

Kwantlen University – 2000

Douglas Academy of Music

Approximately 2.5 years of guitar and music-theory study two time a week beginning in 1995 and ending in 1998.

Additional University Coursework

- Introduction to Psychology 1
- Introduction to Psychology 2
- Introduction to Social Psychology
- Business Writing & Communications

CURRENT DEVELOPMENT & CAREER DIRECTION

I am currently interested in opportunities that provide practical training, employer-supported learning, wage subsidies, employment programs, entrepreneurship training, or other assistance that can help translate my existing experience into sustainable income.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.